Fiscal Year:	FY 2004	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 06/08/2005
PI Name:	Brody, Baruch Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Protecting Scientific Integrity Through Disclosure of Conflicts of Interest		
Division Name:	Human Research		
Program/Discipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	HUMAN RESEARCH--Bioethics		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
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Zip Code:	77030	**Congressional District:**	25
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	98-HEDS-02
Start Date:	10/01/1999	**End Date:**	09/30/2004
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	
No. of PhD Candidates:	0	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	
No. of Master's Candidates:	1	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA JSC
Contact Monitor:		**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:			
Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):	Wray, Nelda (Baylor College of Medicine) McCullough, Larry (Baylor College of Medicine) Wray, Nelda (Baylor College of Medicine)		
Grant/Contract No.:			
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			
Task Description:	This project is designed to help institutions develop ethically justified conflict of interest policies which also are acceptable to the various stakeholders. It has three phases: (1) analyze currently existing policies; (2) survey the stakeholders (subjects, researchers, administrators, bioethicists); and (3) with the help of a panel of experts, develop a set of recommended policies.		
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:			
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	The results of this research will be to help all research institutions develop better conflict of interest policies.		

Task Progress:	This project had three parts. They were a review of institutional policies on conflicts of interest (October 1, 2000-Sept 30, 2001, with a publication in the New England Journal of Medicine in November of 2002), a survey of stakeholders about differences and possible changes (October 1, 2001-September 30, 2002,with a publication in IRB in January of 2003), and the development of a policy document (October 1, 2002-September 30, 2003). Let me briefly summarize the results of each part. Part One We analyzed 235 existing institutional policies and discovered major differences in six sets of issues: (1) the conflicts to be disclosed; (2) the people whose conflicts must be disclosed; (3) to whom the conflicts must be disclosed; (4) when the conflicts must be disclosed; (5) how the conflicts should be managed; (6) what should be done when unreported conflicts are discovered. The conclusion of the paper was that the current regulatory schemes underdefine how institutions should deal with the reporting and management of conflicts of interest. Part Two We surveyed the attitudes of many stakeholders about these differences. These included 158 senior researchers, 297 senior research officials, 195 ethicists, 17 journal editors, 7 agency officials, and 253 research subjects. The major findings were that: (1) all respondents supported wider disclosure, especially to subjects; (2) researchers, while supportive, were less supportive than any of the other groups; (3) subjects and research officials were more supportive,but not as supportive as bioethicists; (4) there was much unclarity about the function of this wider disclosure, even among those supporting it. Part Three In the development of our policy document, we used the results of the surveys from part two, a content analysis of a wide variety of proposed standards, and the advice of an expert panel. The main conclusion was that the current Public Health Service (PHS) regulations need to be supplemented in the following ways: (1) finder fees should be disclosed; (2) all equity interests, regardless of value, should be disclosed; (3) disclosures should be made for trusts controlled by investigators; (4) disclosures should be made to subjects; (5) management strategies going beyond disclosure should be employed when the risks to the subjects and the extent of the conflict are greater; (6) severe penalties are inappropriate except in cases of intentional or repeated failures to disclose. The policy document is completed, but we are still looking for an appropriate venue for publication.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 02/27/2004)